What Is Supabase?

An entry-level tour, with real screenshots

Where does your data live?

Backend

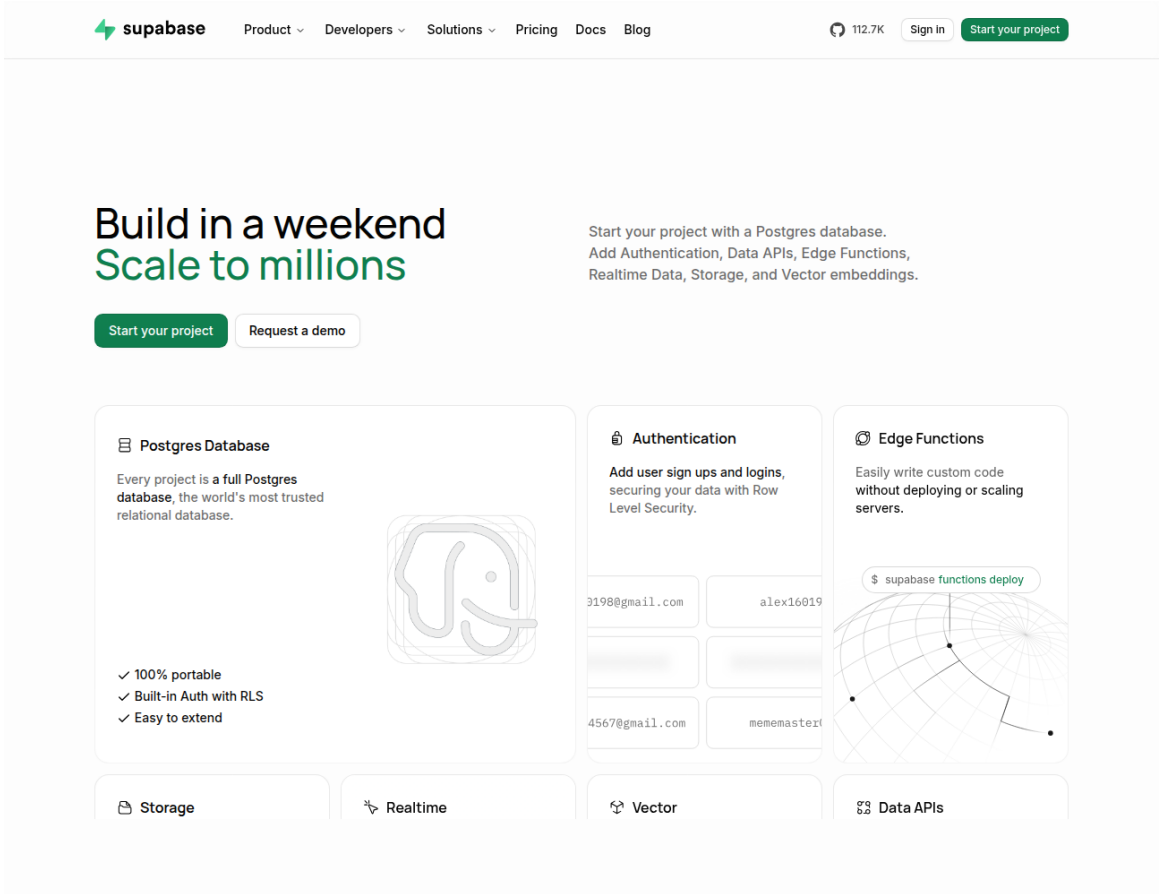
The part of an app you never see

How Supabase Describes Itself

It starts as a database

Then adds what apps need

All in one project



Source

The Four Main Pieces

Piece	What it does
Database	Tables of your data
Auth	Who is signed in
Storage	Files people upload
API	How your page asks

Database

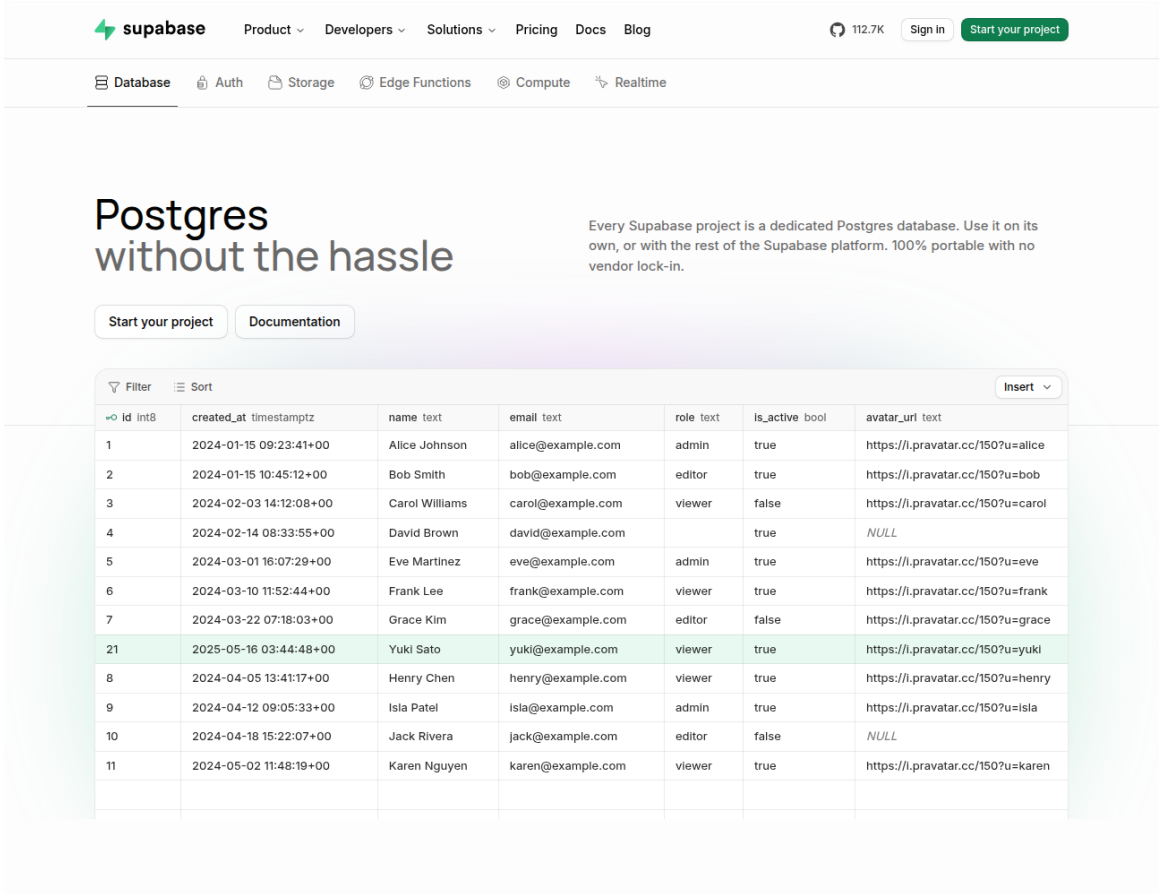
Organised tables your app can read and write

A Table, Concretely

Each row is one record

Each column is a field

A spreadsheet with rules



id int8	created_at timestamptz	name text	email text	role text	is_active bool	avatar_url text
1	2024-01-15 09:23:41+00	Alice Johnson	alice@example.com	admin	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=alice
2	2024-01-15 10:45:12+00	Bob Smith	bob@example.com	editor	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=bob
3	2024-02-03 14:12:08+00	Carol Williams	carol@example.com	viewer	false	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=carol
4	2024-02-14 08:33:55+00	David Brown	david@example.com		true	*NULL*
5	2024-03-01 16:07:29+00	Eve Martinez	eve@example.com	admin	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=eve
6	2024-03-10 11:52:44+00	Frank Lee	frank@example.com	viewer	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=frank
7	2024-03-22 07:18:03+00	Grace Kim	grace@example.com	editor	false	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=grace
21	2025-05-16 03:44:48+00	Yuki Sato	yuki@example.com	viewer	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=yuki
8	2024-04-05 13:41:17+00	Henry Chen	henry@example.com	viewer	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=henry
9	2024-04-12 09:05:33+00	Isla Patel	isla@example.com	admin	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=isla
10	2024-04-18 15:22:07+00	Jack Rivera	jack@example.com	editor	false	*NULL*
11	2024-05-02 11:48:19+00	Karen Nguyen	karen@example.com	viewer	true	https://i.pravatar.cc/150?u=karen

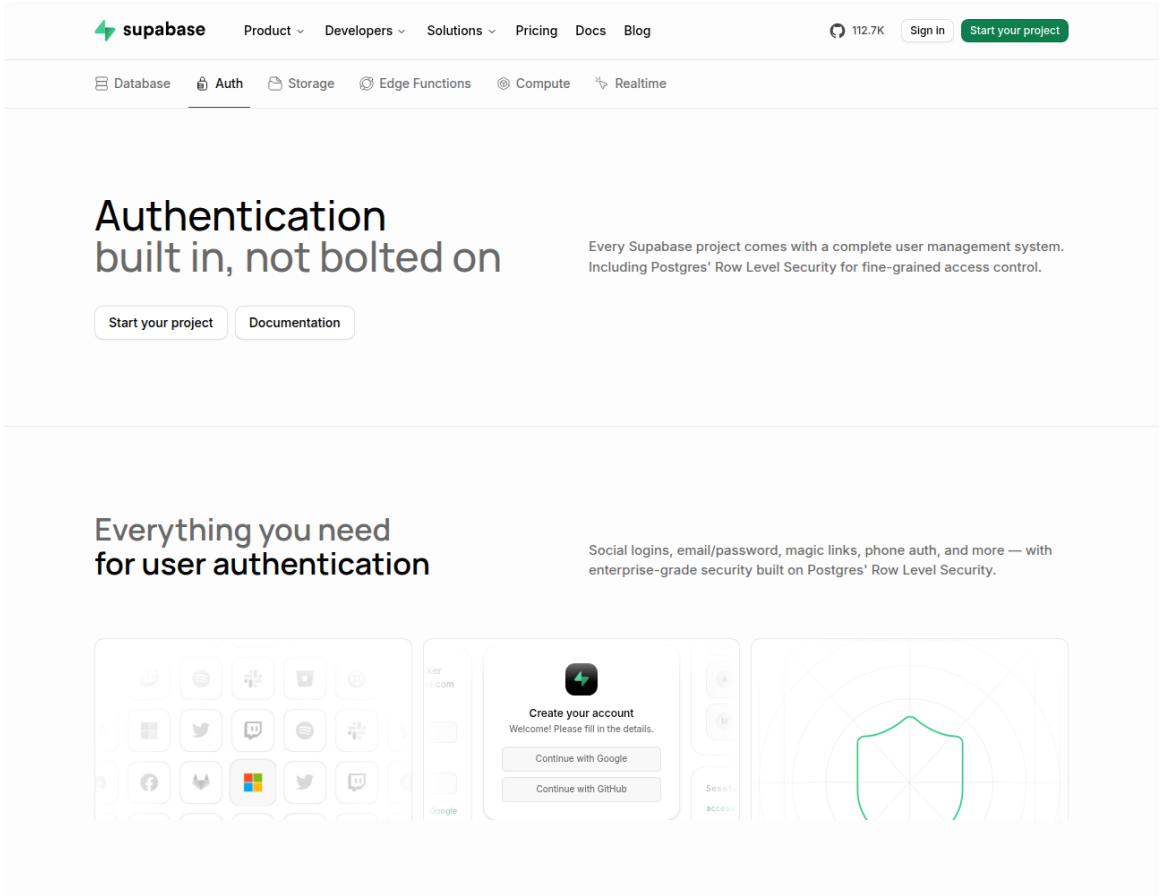
Source

Sign-In, Built In

Email and password

Google, GitHub, others

No login code to write



Source

SQL

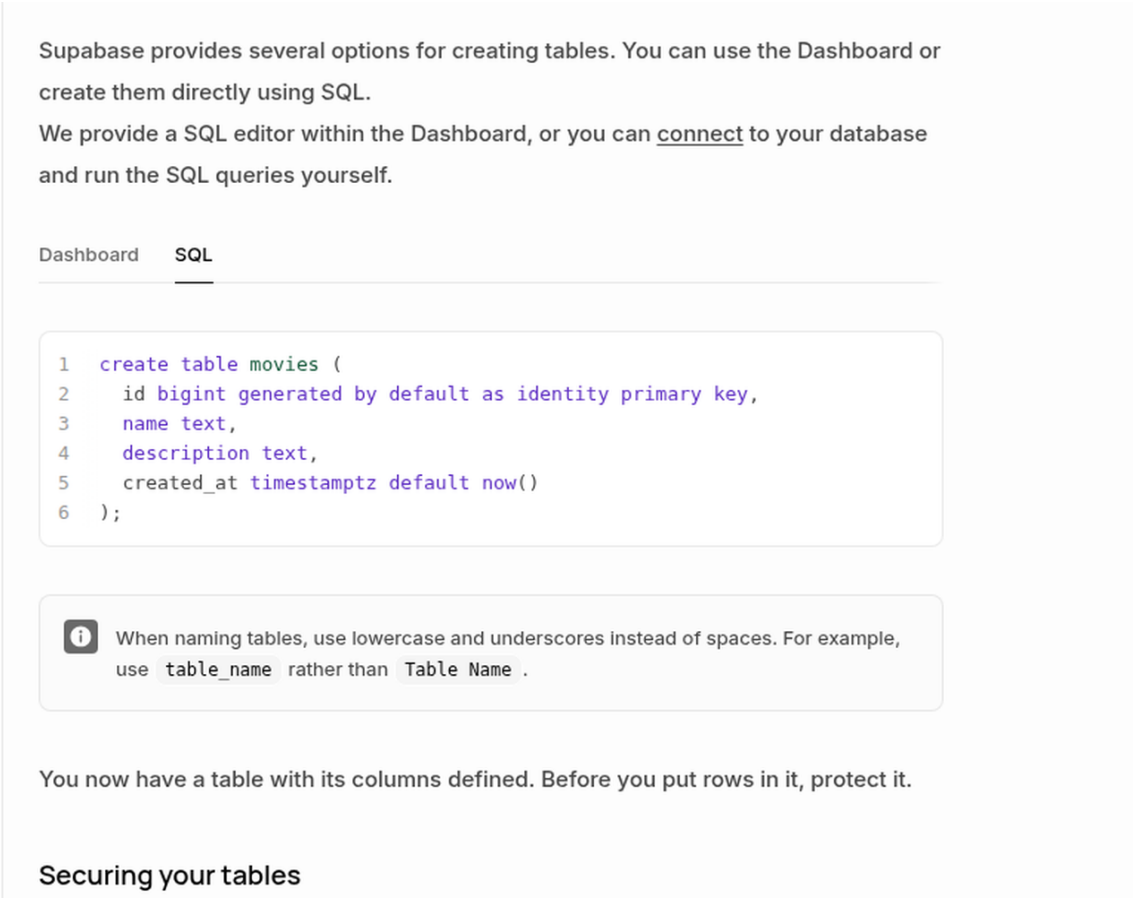
The language for building and asking a database

Two Ways to Make a Table

Click in the Table Editor

Or write it in SQL

We will write SQL



Supabase provides several options for creating tables. You can use the Dashboard or create them directly using SQL.
We provide a SQL editor within the Dashboard, or you can connect to your database and run the SQL queries yourself.

Dashboard SQL

```
1  create table movies (
2    id bigint generated by default as identity primary key,
3    name text,
4    description text,
5    created_at timestamptz default now()
6  );
```

When naming tables, use lowercase and underscores instead of spaces. For example, use `table_name` rather than `Table Name`.

You now have a table with its columns defined. Before you put rows in it, protect it.

Securing your tables

Source

Why We Use SQL

It is written down, so it repeats

It can live in git as a migration

Claude writes it, you review it

It reaches every Postgres type

A first table, in SQL

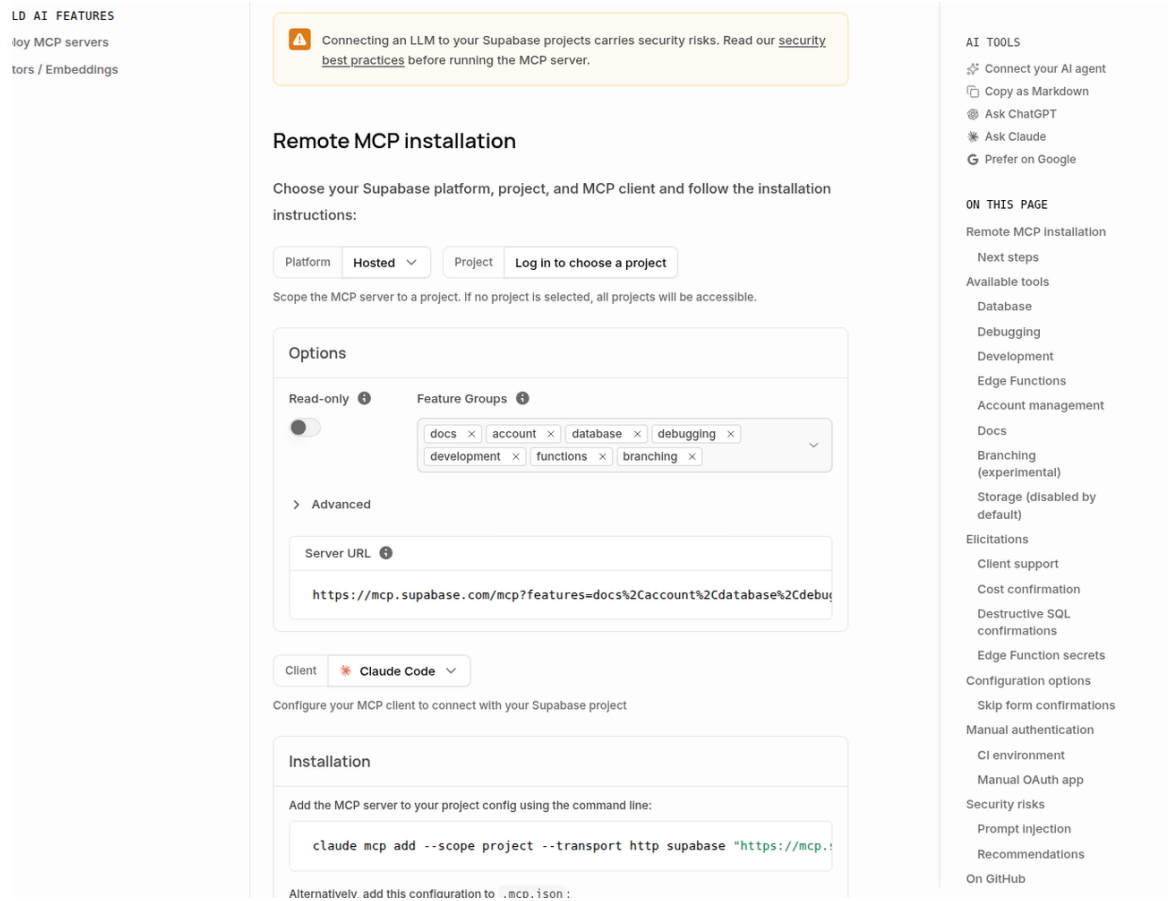
```
create table notes (
  id bigint generated by default
    as identity primary key,
  body text not null,
  created_at timestamptz default now()
);
alter table notes
  enable row level security;
```

Claude Can Build It

Supabase's MCP server

Claude runs the SQL

Approve each step first



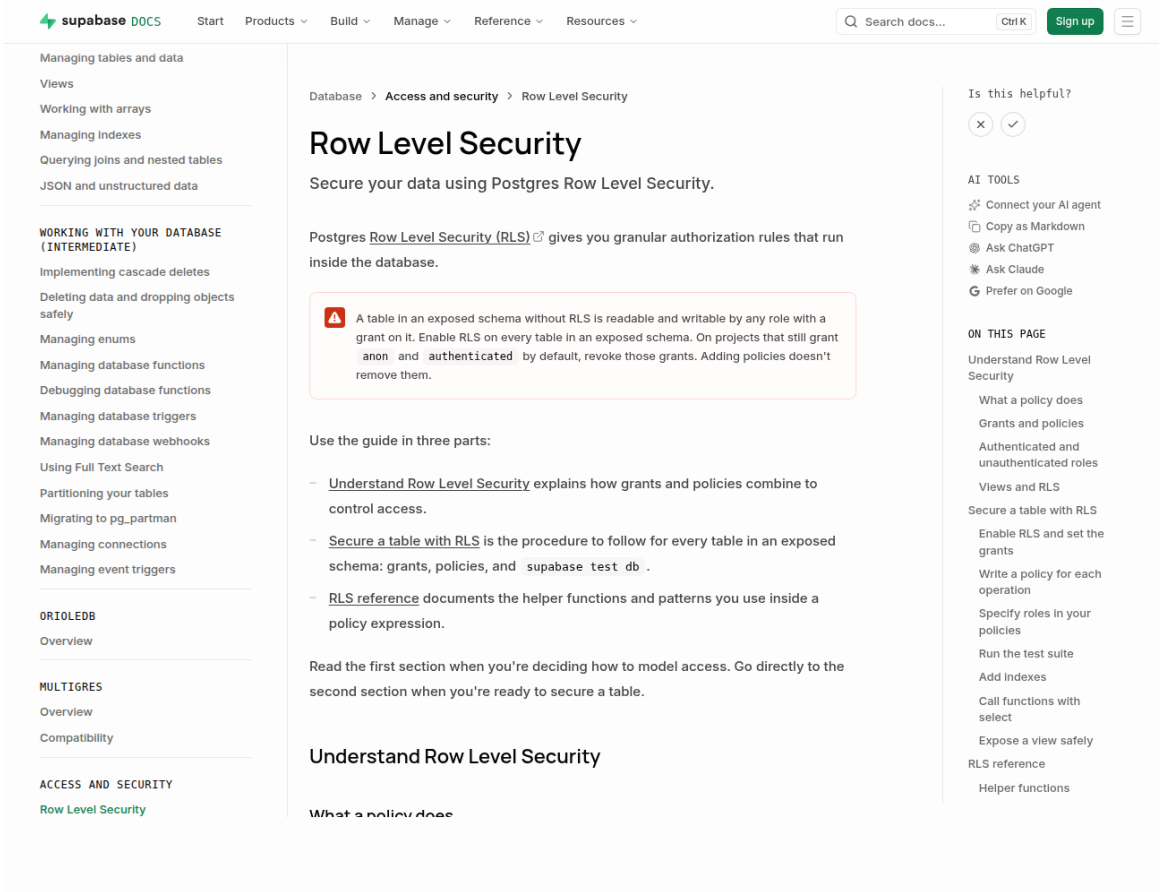
Source

The Rule That Protects It

Turn on row level security

Without it, data is open

Supabase warns you itself



Source

Row Level Security, by Example

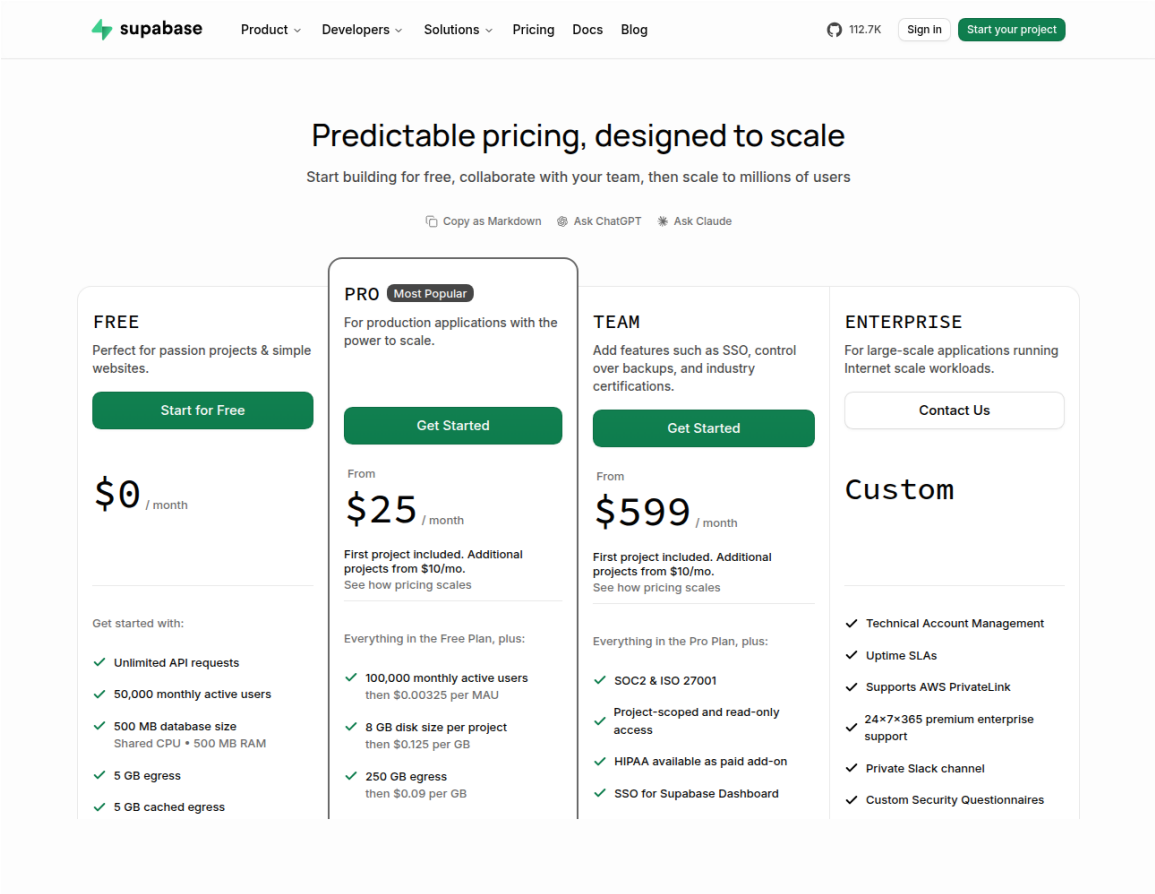
Setting	What a visitor gets
Security off	Every row, read and write
On, with no policy	Nothing at all
On, owner policy	Only their own rows

What It Costs to Start

Free to begin

500 MB of database

50,000 users a month



Source

A Real Project That Uses It

What it stores	Example
Court opinions	Thousands, fetched daily
Is it about asylum?	A yes or a no each
Case details	Country, outcome, more

Screenshots, Captured 21 Oct 2026

Screenshot	Captured from
Homepage, editor, sign-in	supabase.com
Two ways to make a table	supabase.com/docs
Claude and MCP setup	supabase.com/docs
Security warning	supabase.com/docs
Pricing	supabase.com/pricing

Your First Session With Claude

01 Connect Claude to Supabase

One claude mcp add command

02 Describe the table you need

In plain words; Claude writes the SQL

03 Read it, then approve it

Check that RLS is switched on